

ACTION RESEARCH REPORT

Teacher: Kenise Needham-Farquharson

Grade Level: 7

Subject: Spanish

Date Conducted: March–April 2025

Standard: 2.3 – Engages in Reflective Thinking and Action Research

Title:

Enhancing Oral Communication in Spanish through Structured Peer Interaction

Introduction

In my Grade 7 Spanish class, I observed that while students were making progress in vocabulary acquisition and sentence structure, many hesitated to speak aloud in full sentences. I wanted to investigate how structured peer interaction could increase students' confidence and oral fluency.

Research Question

To what extent does regular peer dialogue practice improve oral fluency in Spanish among Grade 7 students?

Methodology

Participants

- 24 Grade 7 students, mixed ability levels

Duration

- 4 weeks (8 sessions in total)

Tools

- Teacher observation log
- Pre- and post-oral fluency checklists
- Student self-assessment forms
- Peer evaluation slips

Intervention

- Twice weekly, students participated in **structured peer dialogues** using sentence prompts and visual supports.
 - Topics included: *¿Cómo eres tú?*, *¿Qué te gusta hacer?*, and *¿Qué estás haciendo?*
 - Students rotated partners, used sentence starters, and practiced in a low-pressure environment.
 - Sessions ended with short reflections or peer feedback.
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Data Collection and Results

Pre-Intervention Observation

- 70% of students responded in single words or short phrases
- Frequent pauses, hesitancy, and English use

Progress Monitoring

- Week 2: Students relied on sentence frames but began forming full responses
- Week 3–4: Increased fluency, better use of *ser*, *gustar*, and adjective agreement

Post-Intervention Outcomes

- 80% of students improved by at least one level on the oral fluency rubric
 - Students reported feeling more confident, especially when given time to prepare
 - Peer assessments showed increased engagement and willingness to help each other
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Reflection

This action research confirmed that structured peer speaking activities can significantly enhance students' comfort and ability to use Spanish orally. It also allowed me to reflect on how providing visual and sentence supports lowers affective barriers to speaking.

Conclusion and Next Steps

I will continue to integrate peer interaction into regular lessons and expand the model to include role-play, video journals, and conversational games. I also plan to involve students in co-creating rubrics and setting oral language goals.
